

# MID-RANGE AI-ENABLED VOICE ASSISTANT SMART SPEAKERS

Nijhum Rudra

In the past few years, technology has not only improved but has also become smarter and made things easier and trouble-free in our lives. In the field of technology, smartphones are considered to be one of the biggest innovations. However, with the advancements in technology, we have started witnessing the evolution of other new products. One such innovation is smart speakers. These are not only wireless and Bluetooth-enabled but now also feature AI-enabled voice assistants and sophisticated design to enhance customer experience.

Popular voice assistants such as Siri, Google Assistant, Cortana, and Alexa have become our trusted digital helpers. With just a command, these play music of our choice, set time according to our preference, and also help children with their homework. As the AI-enabled voice assistant ecosystem is expanding, a huge variety of smart speakers are now available in a wide range of prices.

Before focusing on the latest AI-enabled smart speakers available, let us first check out the essential features that one must look for while buying a smart speaker.

**Sound quality.** This is the most important criterion for

any speaker, be it a smart speaker or a normal music speaker. If you are planning to buy a smart speaker only for giving commands and listening to the news, you can opt for a budget smart speaker. But if you also want a good sound quality with high bass, you should opt for premium smart speakers. Their sound quality and reaction to commands are better as compared to a budget smart speaker.

**Trouble-free use.** This involves accessibility, set-up, and how the speaker reacts to your commands under various environments. Speakers with a low budget and low review scores respond much later even in quiet rooms, and sometimes you may even need to repeat your command several times. A good smart speaker can respond to your command even in a bigger room. But, as of now, even a premium smart speaker cannot respond well in a noisy environment.

**Services and command.** A good smart speaker with sophisticated technology and AI can hold better conversation after you ask your first question. For example, if you ask to show a nearby continental restaurant, the reply can be followed by the question when it will open. This feature is not available in a low-cost smart speaker. In terms of services, a few smart speakers can be connected to Spotify, Netflix, ABC news, Amazon Prime, and many more. You can command directly from your speaker or connect to Bluetooth.

Now, let's find out some of the top smart speakers available in the Indian market with latest technologies.

**Invoxia Triby.** Crafted by Invoxia, Triby is one of the first 'Alexa-enabled' devices built with AVS, which means that you can do almost everything with Alexa on Triby that you can do with Alexa on Echo. It is a new connected family-friendly kitchen device that magnetically sticks to the fridge and



can play music, make calls, display messages, and is voice-activated. You can address Alexa through Triby using the wake word 'Alexa.'

For instance, simply say 'Alexa, play Adele' and Triby can play Adele from Prime Music. In addition, it can make calls over VoIP or with a paired smartphone from 4.5 metres away.

Price: ₹ 14,500

**Amazon Echo (3rd Gen).** Launched by Amazon, this speaker features Dolby for 360 degrees audio with crisp vocals and dynamic bass response. With built-in voice assistant Alexa, this speaker responds to commands for music, news, trivia, scores, weather, alarms, kids rhymes, and stories. Users can access songs in

